



VertiGO!!!

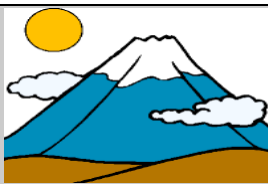
Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 710 August 2008 PO BOX 1 6 2 8 W E L L I N G T O N

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea and coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



Descending Snow Anchor by **Craig Jefferies** – winner 2008 photograph competition



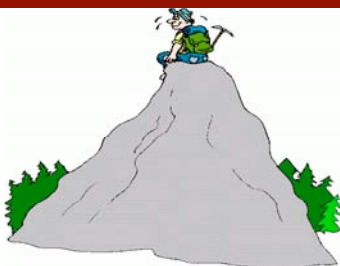
Section Night 4 August 2008

Himalayan Adventures - In October last year Kevin Patterson joined two Aussie's for a month long expedition to climb the 6000m peaks Kongma Tse and Loboche East in the Everest region of Nepal.



Section Trip News

Please send all your fantastic trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.



TRIP REPORTS



Kawakawa Bay Rockclimbing Trip Report

After I did a life-changing summer rock course 2008, I discover that I am such a potential talented rock climber. I wish I had started climbing 20 years ago. I believe that if I had I would be as good as Chris Shama, or even better. I went from knowing pretty much nothing about climbing to being a confident grade 15-16 beater in few weeks. This is huge improvement, isn't it? I joined the NZAC right after the course finished, hoping to meet some even more talented climbers, go for some exciting trips, such as this one – a climbing trip to Kawakawa Bay, hoping I still have a slim chance for being another Chris, getting discount for entering climbing gyms to fulfill my dream, and a free subscription of Climber magazines (yeah...).

There are 6 people in this trip: James Wright (the Club committee, trip leader), Kevin Patterson (the Club committee, experienced climber), Catherine Moger (the Club administrator, experienced climber), Shichang Hou (club member, a newbie but has potential), Marcus Manning (2008 Summer Rock course instructor), Steve Minchin (club member, confident climber, climbs without belay device).

After a few weeks eagerly waiting, at the weekend of 10th May 2008, we met at Wellington Railway Station – the place where I found people in the club like to meet for climbing trips. I am always wondering

if the staff at the Station notice we are using their place and will eventually blame or even charge us for using their resources. Four people bring their own ropes which means there is no shortage of rope. Steve has the biggest and heaviest pack but he didn't have a belay device, so we were one belay device short. I was wondering if this has happened before in the club trips.

Kevin kindly offered his Odyssey - seats 7 with roof pod, nice and comfy, perfectly fits 6 people. We were like a bunch of happy bees and headed to our destination, despite the uncertainty of bad weather.

After a few good hours driving and had a nice kebab meal at arguably the best kebab restaurant in the country, we arrived at camp site by Lake Taupo. It started raining but for some reason it didn't upset us.

The rain stopped in the next morning, but there was still no sun. We took a water taxi to this small but nice Kawakawa Bay camp site. On the way James pointed out a place where people can do water solo. "Water Solo", what a cool term, I had never heard this before, after I understood what it means I started to imagine myself coming here in summer and doing it.

Kawakawa Bay, is located on the northern shores of Lake Taupo, in the bays west of Kinloch. It offers an array of both sport and traditional climbing routes on the Crack walls, the Bluff and the Point overlooking the beautiful Kawakawa Bay.

Once we landed on the bay we didn't waste our time by quickly set up our tents and started to search for rocks. First we came to the Crack Walls. When I was about to jump on the rocks James said the rocks were still wet and there would be little friction between shoes and rocks, hence it was dangerous. True, true, I felt I just learned a thing. See, you always can learn something from experienced climbers.

We kept walking and were heading to the Point to see if we could find some dry rocks. The rocks were slightly drier than those of the Crack Walls. The sun still hadn't come out and it was already afternoon. We decided not to wait and chose a few routes that were dry enough to climb. Mellow Yellow (15), a 2 pitches climbing, Kevin lead it. This was a starter for me and Kevin. After that I did Raw Umber (15) with Marcus (lead) and Steve, to testify my absolute Grade 15 skills. My main course is Human Intervention (18, James lead it). I climbed after Marcus and Catherine. It was not horribly difficult for me so I feel quite happy that I finished it and had a grade 18 under my belt. It was my first attempt on grade 18 outdoor. Kevin and Steve were having fun on High Hopes (16) which is right next to Human Intervention. I constantly checked out what they were up to and share their happy climbing while I was in the middle of climbing. I was thinking High Hopes could be my dessert but it was getting dark. We didn't think walking on the same track in dark would be as fun. So we called it a day. By the way, we had sunset on the way back. Kawakawa bay and the lake are terribly beautiful with sunset, we stop for a few times just to enjoy the gorgeous view which serves us well after climbing.

At dinner time James lit up a nice fire to keep us warm. Everyone sat around the fire and made their own dinner. I only had some cans of chicken and sardine fish. I ate them with wraps. It wasn't too bad at first, until I saw James was cooking his steak, frying pok choi with garlic, soy sauce, and all that stuff, on his fancy and powerful cookers; it looks like he brought an entire kitchen. Kevin had his expensive gourmet camp food that I had never seen before. Steven drank at least 4 liters of soup. He started making food and eating before everyone else, and he still keep eating after everyone finished. At the end he had another liter of hot milo. No wonder he had the heaviest and biggest pack, got not place for a belay device.

We were all happy about the sun finally came out the next morning. We quickly finished our breakfast (by the way, I had my sardine fish wrap again) and came to the Crack wall. The rocks were nice and dry. Marcus, Steve and Catherine started with Rohans Little Sister(16) while James and me were doing the Gecko Groove(16, a classic trad. climbing route in Kawakawa Bay). Everyone looked fit and was in a good climbing mood. I guess everyone had a good night sleep, or simply because we had the sun. Then I climbed the Little Sister and finished with textbook-style which made me feel even better. I really like the rock has very nice friction and find I can grip the rock nicely - even on holds that are mono and small.

Soon we started to tackle slightly more difficult routes. Marcus lead climbing on the Great Scott (20) which is right next to the Gecko Groove. Then Catherine finished it easily. All these gave me impression that I probably could do it too. So I started to climb this, the hardest one I have ever done. It was already hard for me from the beginning and it got harder and harder when I climb up, which I didn't expected. It took me a long time including a few breaks on the way and with sort of "anti-textbook" ugly style. It almost killed me. Boosted by successfully finishing this Great Scott, Catherine enthusiastically made an attempt on Rohans Arete (22), which James lead it. Although it took Catherine a while to reach to the top everyone was impressed by her great achievement and determination.

By the time Catherine finished climbing the water taxi was about to arrive. We rushed back to the camp site, cleaned up and packed all the stuff just before the water taxi arrived. On the way we took a look at those beautiful rocks that we didn't have time to climb and were thinking...next time. I had a look at that water solo place again, and was thinking...yes...next time.

This is my first official club trip. We are glad that we made it and luckily the weather was with us, well, eventually. I immensely enjoy my first club trip and only could hope the club will organize more trips. I will be the first one to sign up, no doubt about it. Okay, forget about all that self-praise stuff, I am not a good climber and probably don't have the talent either but that doesn't stop me enjoying climbing at all. I can tell you that I have as much passion as other good climbers. I can't wait for the summer. I can imagine that I could be out at these places in most weekends and will see you all there.

Shichang Hou



Transalpinism in the Ötztal Alps

Early July saw myself and Hannah McGregor in Innsbruck to meet ex-Wellingtonians(now Londonites) Ben and Kathryn Clendon and Tim Baker for a ferret around on the impressive snowfields of the Ötztal Alps. After a false start up the Gurgler Ferner (with only a 30m half-rope and facing a 20m abseil we were quite literally staring down the Gurgler), we back tracked and headed up a different valley from Vent. We scrambled up a chossy pile of junk called Saykogel that was around 3000 high and descended the Hojochferner (a glacier). 10 or 15 years ago climbers found the body of an early transalpinist just on the other side of a pass from the Hojochferner, it was a pretty impressive trip by the Ötzi man around 5600 years ago. We then gained the huge Gepatschferner snowfield via an easy but rather high pass from the Guslaferner. It would have been nice to spend a day or three up there climbing a huge number of peaks and peering in to Italy but London was calling (for some) so we post holed our way down to the Rauhekopfhütte, and a convivial night with the Frankfurt section of the DAV (German Alpine Club). Those guys are off to climb Pik Lenin in Krgystan in a week or so. We made our way back to Sölden via the Taschachferner and Mittleberg (glaciers) the latter of which is rather spoilt by enormous

ski developments. There was plenty of thunder and lightening most afternoons and the last lot caught us on the Piztaler Jöcht which made for a fairly hasty descent into the Rettenbachtal valley and a bus ride down to Sölden. Good times.

Richard Davies



CLASSIFIED



For Sale.....

Maps - near full set of NZMS260 series (12 missing)

- selection of 21 Infomaps and Parkmaps covering parks Bay of Is to Fiordland
- selection of 35 StreetFinder maps covering most provincial towns and cities
- one map cabinet

\$250 for full set or \$5 each



CLUB NOTICES



Ski Mountaineering Races 2008

EVENT DETAILS

Dynafit Ski Mountaineering Clinic, Mt Cheeseman Ski Area, August 2nd

(<http://dynafit.co.nz/events.html>)

Rainbow Randonee Race, Rainbow Ski Area, August 9th

Manganui Randonee Race, Mt Taranaki, August 16th

Black Diamond Backcountry Blast, Ohau Ski Area, August 30th

Scarpa Craigieburner International Open, Craigieburn Ski Area, September 6th

Deuter Ruapehu Ripper, Turoa Ski Area, September 20th



Rafting Trip

Due to the success of this trip in Feb 2008 we are running it again in 2009. Anyone keen to participate, phone Roger Brown 03 686 0977 (evenings)

Day 1 – Friday 6th Feb (Waitangi Day)

Leave Timaru with 4x4 Tours NZ for Back Hut, Mesopotamia. Walk to St Winifred's Stream Hut.

Day 2 – Saturday 7th Feb

Denniston Pass/Bivvy Bettison Stream

Day 3 – Sunday 8th Feb

Walk to Scone Hut

Day 4 – Monday 9th Feb

Raft out the Perth River with Hidden Valley's i.e. Grant South. Stay at Whataroa Pub the night.

Day 5 – Tuesday 10th Feb

Return to Timaru



Copy of a press release from metservice

<http://metservice.co.nz/default/index.php?alias=extendednzmountain>

Forecast enhancements benefit trampers and boaties. Press Release by New Zealand Government at 11:59 am, 30 Jun 2008.

A new extended range weather forecasting system for the country's mountain regions, offering greater assurance and security to the outdoor community, has been welcomed by the Minister for Transport Safety Harry Duynhoven. The Extended Brief Mountain Forecast, which will be available on Radio New Zealand National from Monday 30 June, will lengthen the period of MetService's forecast for the major mountain areas of New Zealand from two to five days. "It's important in a country that has a keen history of mountaineering and tramping that we provide long range weather forecasts so people can plan recreational trips and activities with more certainty," Mr Duynhoven said. Extending the period of the Brief Mountain Forecast has been made possible by modern forecasting techniques and technologies coupled with increased funding. As part of Budget 2008 MetService, a State Owned Enterprise, received an additional \$4.8 million in funding over the next four years.



ALPINE COURSES AND INSTRUCTION



Alpine Outdoor First Aid Course August 23 - 24 **For trip leaders and instructors**

Ever wondered what you would do if there were a serious accident on a trip you were leading or an instruction course you were teaching on? Find out what to do when the faecal matter hits the propeller.

Where: At Delta Corner Ruapehu, NZAC hut; where we go for most instruction and many trips, under conditions we will be exposed to on a day in the mountains.

When: Saturday August 23, 8am and finishes August 24 Sunday 4pm.

Your bunk will be booked for Friday and Saturday nights. We recommend arriving on Friday night.

Instructors: Pete Zimmer and Paul Chaplow, experienced alpine instructors, educators and climbers.

Delivered through: creative catastrophes and realistic scenarios in the conditions you will need to deal with.

Content:

1. Knowledge of treatment of injuries and medical issues
2. Knowledge of crisis management in an alpine environment including:
group management, communication, evacuation pathways.

Cost: \$120 per person, includes all resources, instruction and your hut fees. This course is subsidised by the New Zealand Mountain Safety Council.

How to apply: Get a recommendation from your section's instruction or trips coordinator and email it to chris@alpineclub.org.nz.



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Alpine Club Members with card can climb anytime for \$8.
Monday nights show your members card and climb for \$5.



CLUB TRIPS



AND HERE ARE THE CLUB TRIPS

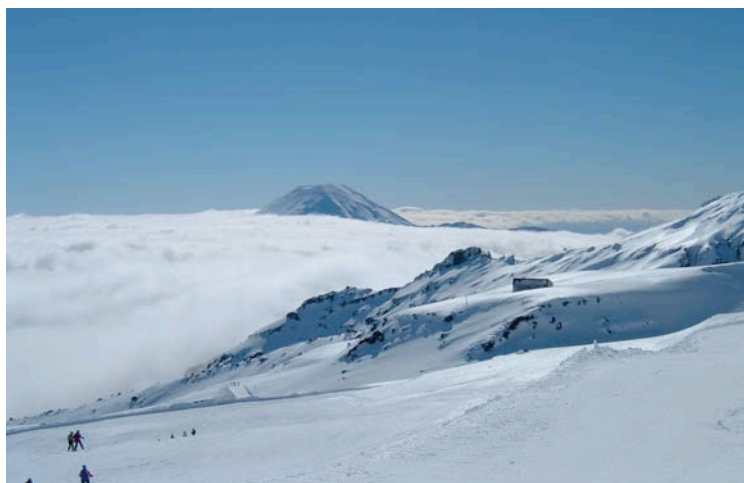
Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the section, so if anyone has an idea about a trip, no matter how vague, send an email to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz).

Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us, or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going.

18-20Jul08 - Ruapehu North - Te Heu Heu, Dome, and Paretetaitonga – Leader Steve Merchant – Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

The plan is to drive up to Whakapapa, and climb up to Delta Corner Hut on Friday night. On Saturday we will stroll up to the crater, inspect the Dome shelter (2672m) and attempt Paratetaitonga (2751m), returning to Delta Corner for the evening. On Sunday we will return to the crater and attempt Te Heu Heu (2732m) along the main ridge, descending the skifield to the car park and home thereafter. Contact Steve at 021 272 1151 or email me at smerchant@bto-ltd.co.nz



North Ruapehu with the NZAC hut, Pinnacles, and Ngaruhoe

22-24Aug08 - Ruapehu South - Girdlestone and Tahurangi – Leader Scott Taylor – Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

On Friday night we will drive up to Ohakune and either tent near the mountain road or stay at the backpackers. Saturday we will ascend the highest point on Ruapehu = Tahurangi peak (2797m) returning for a pub meal at the Powderhorn in the evening. On Sunday we will attempt Girdlestone (2658m), the outlying peak on the right of Tahurangi by crossing the Mangaehuehu Glacier. Contact Scott at 027 410 0736 or email me at brittenv1000@hotmail.com.



Ruapehu Crater Lake

19-21Sep08 - Egmont - via Tahurangi lodge – Leader Nigel Roberts – Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

We will leave early on Friday afternoon (4pm) to North Egmont car park, from where we will tramp up to Tahurangi Lodge (1.5h) arriving ca. 11pm. On Saturday we will ascend Egmont (2518m) via the Lizard, returning to the lodge for the evening. On Sunday we will explore the rock walls of Warwick Castle (bring

a rope for this trip) towards the eastern side before returning to the car park. Contact Nigel at 463 5288 (work) or email me at nigel.roberts@vuw.ac.nz



Mt Egmont Crater Wall

24-27Oct08 – Mt Manukau (2608m) – Seaward Kaikouras – Labour Weekend - Leader James Wright – Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

Spring snow trip to end the northern alpine season! Come on this challenging 3 day climb in the Seaward Kaikouras. On Friday night we'll take the ferry and stay near the road end. Saturday will be the trip in up the Manukau River followed by a climb up to a high Alpine basin where we'll tent overnight. On Sunday we'll attempt the summit via the north ridge. No ropes required. Contact James at 232 7748 or by email at james.wright@xtra.co.nz



Mt Manakau



SPECIAL THANKS

A huge **Thank You** to Kate Melzer for another successful Banff Film Festival from the committee. It went off without a hitch and we have had wonderful feedback. We appreciate all your hard work!!

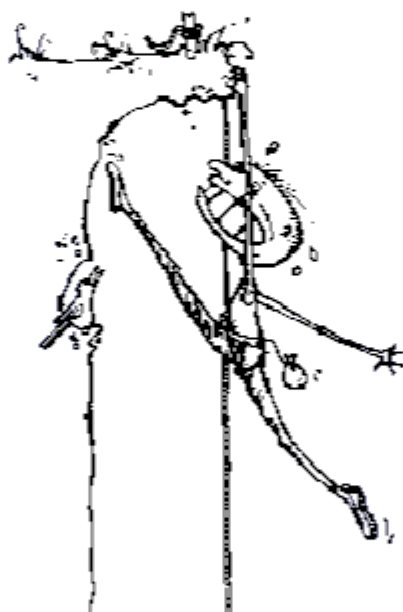


WELLINGTON SECTION: 2008 CONTACT LIST

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Vice Chairperson	VACANT		
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Treasurer	Karen Domaneschi	TREASURER <i>or</i> KD	N/A
National Representative	James Wright	JW	N/A
	Judy Reid	JR	
Instruction: AIC	VACANT	AIC	N/A
Instruction: RIC	Blair Hiscoke	SUMMER ROCK	N/A
National Instruction Rep	VACANT		N/A
Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	KF	N/A
Trips	Kevin Patterson	TRIPS <i>or</i> KP	N/A
	Gwen Rashbrooke	TRIPS <i>or</i> GR	N/A
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	Peter Shanahan	PS2	N/A
Committee Members	VACANT		
	VACANT		N/A

	VACANT		N/A
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